DAY 09 • STUDENT HANDOUT

Case Follow-up and Escalation

Verifying results with stakeholders, checking scan logs for failed actions, and escalating to the appropriate authority

Qualification	Cyber Threat Monitoring Level I
Unit of Competency	CS-ICT251101 Monitor and Report Cyber Threats
Coverage	Element 4 Conduct case follow-up: Performance Criteria 4.1–4.3; Range of Variables: Appropriate authority; Required Knowledge 4.1 Log and detection management, 4.2 Knowledge in organization SOP
Duration	8 hours (1 training day)

Learning Objectives

At the end of this session, you should be able to:

1. Verify the results of a scan with the customer, client or stakeholder, in plain language (PC 4.1).
2. Check security solution scan logs for failed actions as per SOP (PC 4.2).
3. Escalate a failed action to the appropriate authority as per SOP (PC 4.3).
4. Write a complete escalation record and follow up when there is no response.
5. Protect personal data and credentials while communicating with stakeholders.

1. A Case Is Not Finished Until …

… the person who owns the computer confirms the problem is gone, or someone with the authority to fix it has taken it over. Element 4 of the Competency Standards covers this follow-up: verify the results with the stakeholder, check the scan logs for failed actions, and escalate the failures. In the lab you follow SOC-SOP-05 Case Follow-up and Escalation (~/day9/soc_followup_sop.txt).

2. Verify the Results with the Stakeholder (PC 4.1)

The stakeholder is the customer, client or employee responsible for the affected computer. Find them in the directory and call the directory number (never a number from a suspicious message).

Step	What	Example
Tell	What was found, what the security solution did, what they must do now	"We found a trojan in payslip_viewer.exe. The antivirus quarantined it. Please restart your laptop."
Ask	Are the symptoms gone? Anything unusual?	"Do you still see pop-ups or slow performance?"
Record	Who confirmed, when, and what they said	"Maria Reyes confirmed at 13:05: laptop normal."

Reply	Next Step (F1.4)
Confirmed resolved	Close the case and record the confirmation
Symptoms remain	Re-open the case and re-check the host (Day 8)
No reply	Try again after 2 hours; after 2 tries, email the stakeholder's supervisor

> **NOTE — Talking to stakeholders**
> Use plain words, not event IDs. Never send or ask for passwords. Share only what the stakeholder needs: a payroll officer does not need the details of another employee's infection (Data Privacy Act, RA 10173).

3. Check the Scan Logs for Failed Actions (PC 4.2)

Event ID	Failed Action	Example Cause
1118	Remediation action failed (non-critical)	File in use by another process
1119	Remediation action failed (critical)	Access denied
1002	Scan stopped before it finished	The user restarted the PC
1005	Scan failed	Engine error
2001	Security intelligence update failed	Connection timed out

Not failures: 1000 scan started, 1001 scan finished, 1116 detected, 1117 action taken, 2000 update succeeded. In the lab: grep -E ",(1118|1119|1002|1005|2001)," ~/day9/scan_logs.csv

4. Escalate to the Appropriate Authority (PC 4.3)

The Competency Standards list four appropriate authorities. SOC-SOP-05 says which one receives each failed action. Check the rules in order; the FIRST rule that matches decides.

Rule	When	Escalate To	Response Target
E1	Ransomware or confirmed data loss affecting a Tier 1 asset	Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)	15 min
E2	Any other failed action on a red flag or on a Tier 1 asset	Information Security Manager	30 min
E3	The security solution itself failed (1005, 2001)	Security solution vendor (copy the IT Department Manager)	Next business day
E4	Any other failed action on a business computer	IT Department Manager	2 hours

TIP — Order matters

FIN-PC-03 is only a Tier 2 workstation, but its ransomware encrypted the Tier 1 FS-01 Finance share, so rule E1 applies (CISO), not E2. A stopped scan is normally E4, but on ENG-PC-11, the source of Day 5's PE infection, it is E2.

The Escalation Record

- Phone first, then the escalation record by email (~/day9/escalation_template.txt)
- Ticket, escalated to, rule, time called, host and tier, what failed (event ID and detail)
- Impact (what is still at risk) and what you need from them (a decision or an action)
- Response target and the time you will follow up if there is no answer

Key Terms

Term	Meaning
Stakeholder	The customer, client or employee responsible for the affected system
Case follow-up	Checking that the case really ended well, or handing it to someone who can finish it
Failed action	A remediation, scan or update that did not complete
Escalation	Passing a problem to a person with more authority or expertise, with all the facts
Appropriate authority	The role the SOP names for a type of problem (IT manager, information security manager, vendor, CISO)
CISO	Chief Information Security Officer: the executive responsible for information security
Response target	How quickly the authority is expected to respond

References

- TESDA Competency Standards — Cyber Threat Monitoring Level I (ICT Sector), unit CS-ICT251101, Element 4 and Range of Variables 7.
- NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 3, Incident Response Recommendations and Considerations for Cybersecurity Risk Management (communication and escalation).
- Microsoft Learn — Microsoft Defender Antivirus event IDs (1000–1119, 2000, 2001).
- Republic Act No. 10173 (Data Privacy Act of 2012) and NPC Circular 2016-03 (personal data breach management).